

Mannerist sculpture

In reaction to social, political and religious disruptions, sculptors also began exaggerating and distorting their images. Subjects were predominantly religious and mythological. Overall, Mannerist sculpture was thoughtful, spiritually intense and experimental. The greatest Mannerist sculptor was Flemish-born Jean de Bologne, who settled in Florence and became known as Giambologna (1529–1608). Extremely successful during his lifetime, he produced animated figures in marble and bronze, from miniature to monumental. His dynamic, complex and graceful figures often take poses described as *figura serpentinata* – a human figure twisting around a central core, in a coiling, contorted stance.

Benvenuto Cellini (1500–71), another important Mannerist, also lived and worked primarily in Florence until he was exiled for duelling. A sculptor, goldsmith, engraver, pupil of Michelangelo and author of a celebrated autobiography, he had many influential patrons, including Francis I and Cosimo de' Medici.



Giambologna, *Hercules and Nessus*, 1599